

23. And all the blessings wherewith the Lord hath blessed me and my seed shall belong to Jacob and his seed alway.

24. And in his seed shall my name be blessed, and the name of my fathers, Shem, and Noah, and Enoch, and Mahalalel, and Enos, and Seth, and Adam. 25. And these shall serve

To lay the foundations of the heaven,

And to strengthen the earth,

And to renew all the luminaries which are in the firmament."

26. And he called Jacob before the eyes of Rebecca his mother, and kissed him, and blessed him, and said:

27. "Jacob, my beloved son, whom my soul loveth, may God bless thee from above the firmament, and may He give thee all the blessings wherewith He blessed Adam, and Enoch, and Noah, and Shem; and all the things of which He told me, and all the things which He promised to give me, may He cause to cleave to thee and to thy seed for ever, according to the days of heaven above the earth. 28. And the spirits of Mastêmâ shall not rule over thee or over thy seed to turn thee from the Lord, who is thy God from henceforth for ever. 29. And may the Lord God be a father to thee and thou the first-born son, and to the people alway. Go in peace, my son." 30. And they both went forth together from Abraham. 31. And Rebecca loved Jacob, with all her heart and with all her soul, very much more than Esau; but Isaac loved Esau much more than Jacob.

24. This list of righteous patriarchs is peculiar for its omissions and its insertions. With regard to Mahalelel nothing special is known. On the other hand, the omission of Methuselah is strange. In later times opinions were divided as to the character of Adam. Some held him to be a saint (חסיד Erub. 18b), others an atheist

(נפח בעיקר Sanh. 38b). See rabbinic references in Singer, pp. 125-126.

25. See note on i. 29. Cf. Is. li. 16.

27. *All the blessings wherewith, etc.* Cf. xxii. 13.

28. See note on xv. 31-32. Evil spirits have dominion over the Gentiles but not over Israel.

Abraham admonishes his sons and his sons' sons to work righteousness, observe circumcision, and refrain from impurity and idolatry, 1-10. Dismisses them with gifts, 11. Dwelling-places of the Ishmaelites and of the sons of Keturah, 12-13. (Cf. Gen. xxv. 5-6.)

2052
(? 2045) A.M.

XX. And in the forty-second jubilee, in the first year of the †seventh† week, Abraham called Ishmael, and his twelve sons, and Isaac and his two sons, and the six sons of Keturah, and their sons. 2. And he commanded them that they should observe the way of the Lord; that they should work righteousness, and love each his neighbour, and act on this manner amongst all men; that they should each so walk with regard to them as to do judgment and righteousness on the earth. 3. That they should circumcise their sons, according to the covenant which He had made with them, and not deviate to the right hand or the left of all the paths which the Lord had commanded us; and that we should keep ourselves from all fornication and uncleanness, [and renounce from amongst us all fornication and uncleanness]. 4. And if any woman or maid commit fornication amongst you, burn her with fire, and let them not commit fornication with her after their eyes and their heart; and let them not take to themselves wives from the daughters of Canaan; for the seed of Canaan will be rooted out of the

XX. 1. †Seventh†. "Seventh" seems corrupt for "sixth." The present text makes the date 2052 or the year after Abraham's death. If we read "sixth" it would give 2045. See note on xxi. 1. Thus some time would intervene between the dismissal of Ishmael and his sons to their distant homes (xx. 11) and the return of Ishmael and Jacob to celebrate the feast of weeks (xxii. 1).

His twelve sons. See Gen. xxv. 13-15.

2. *Men*=sab'ë emended from šab'ë, "war."

3. *Circumcise their sons.* Sanh. 59 b contains a discussion as to whether circumcision was obligatory on Ishmael's and Keturah's sons in conformity with Gen. xvii. 9. Owing to Gen. xxi. 12 it was held not to extend to Esau's descendants.

[*And renounce . . . uncleanness*]. Bracketed as a dittography.

4. This halacha does not agree exactly with those in Leviticus and Deuteronomy, etc., but with that implied in Gen. xxxviii. 24. According to Deut. xxii. 23 sqq.; Ezek. xvi. 40; Lev. xx. 10 the adulteress was to be put to

land. 5. And he told them of the judgment of the giants, and the judgment of the Sodomites, how they had been judged on account of their wickedness, and had died on account of their fornication, and uncleanness, and mutual corruption through fornication.

6. "And guard yourselves from all fornication and uncleanness,

And from all pollution of sin,

Lest ye make our name a curse,

And your whole life a hissing,

And all your sons to be destroyed by the sword,

And ye become accursed like Sodom,

And all your remnant as the sons of Gomorrah.

7. I implore you, my sons, love the God of heaven,

And cleave ye to all His commandments.

And walk not after their idols, and after their uncleannesses,

8. And make not for yourselves molten or graven gods ;

For they are vanity,

And there is no spirit in them ;

For they are work of (men's) hands,

And all who trust in them, trust in nothing.

Serve them not, nor worship them,

9. But serve ye the Most High God, and worship Him continually :

death by stoning, whereas death by fire was reserved for the priest's daughter who had played the whore, Lev. xxi. 9. On the other hand Gen. xxxviii. 24, where Judah proposes to burn Tamar, comes under neither of these regulations. Tamar was still, according to custom, the wife of Er—for Shelah was simply to act as Er's representative—and should thereupon have been stoned according to the Levitical law. See notes on xli. 25, 26.

5. *Fornication, and uncleanness, and . . . corruption.* See note on vii. 21.

6. *Make our name a curse, and your whole life a hissing.* Based on Is. lxxv. 15; Jer. xxix. 18. Cf. Eth. En. v. 6. For "a hissing" (so Latin) *a* gives "a threatening" and *bcd* "a cause of boasting."

8. Cf. xii. 5, xxii. 18.

Molten or graven gods. Cf. Deut. xxvii. 15.

Serve them not, nor worship them. Exod. xx. 5.